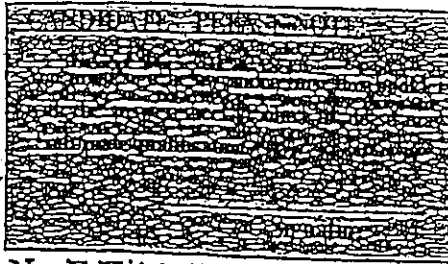


FORM TP 2011007



TEST CODE 01218010

JANUARY 2011

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION

ENGLISH A

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

90 minutes

03 JANUARY 2011 (p.m.)

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This test consists of 60 items. You will have 90 minutes to answer them.
2. In addition to this test booklet, you should have an answer sheet.
3. Each item in this test has four suggested answers, lettered (A), (B), (C), (D). Read each item you are about to answer and decide which answer is best.
4. On your answer sheet, find the number which corresponds to your item and shade the space having the same letter as the answer you have chosen. Look at the sample item below.

Sample Item

Choose the word that BEST completes the meaning of each sentence.

Someone who is suffering from influenza needs to be isolated as the disease is _____.

- (A) lasting
- (B) serious
- (C) contagious
- (D) destructive

Sample Answer

- (A) (B) (C) (D)

Items 1 - 5

Instructions: Each sentence has either one or two words missing. Choose from the four options the word or pair of words which **BEST** completes the meaning of the sentence. Mark your choice on the answer sheet.

1. Though the boy's misdeeds were well known, the _____ parent refused to punish his son.
- (A) wise
(B) lenient
(C) severe
(D) concerned
2. To conceal his true activities, the spy quickly _____ a plausible excuse for his presence there.
- (A) fabricated
(B) divulged
(C) explained
(D) disguised
3. He _____ the invitation to the party when he remembered the examination for which he had to _____.
- (A) accepted invigilate
(B) refused assist
(C) declined prepare
(D) acknowledged research
4. Some children, although health-conscious, are unusually _____ to _____ diseases.
- (A) inclined fatal
(B) immune incurable
(C) susceptible infectious
(D) indifferent contagious
5. The new owners will be asked to carry out the plan as far as possible, and will be expected to _____ the policy of cost reduction approved by the board.
- (A) adapt
(B) state
(C) develop
(D) implement

Items 6-10

Instructions: Each sentence is followed by four sentences. Choose the one NEAREST in meaning to the original sentence. Be sure to read all four choices before you select your answer, and then mark your choice on your answer sheet.

6. After the football match that Trinity High School won, there was much jubilation among supporters, but a dozen fans were injured.
- (A) A dozen fans were injured during the celebrations after Trinity High School won the football match.
- (B) Trinity High School won the football match but a dozen fans were injured during the chaos that followed.
- (C) Although Trinity High School won the football match, jubilant fans injured a dozen supporters.
- (D) Trinity High School won the football match causing jubilant supporters to injure a dozen fans.
7. The government's new-found wealth, oil, became the salvation of the country's economy.
- (A) The economic benefits gained from the new oil discovery enabled the government to save the nation's economy.
- (B) The discovery of oil by the government added greatly to the profitable mineral resources of the country.
- (C) The oil helped the government to increase its economic benefits to the nation.
- (D) The now rich government enabled the economy to prosper by selling oil to non-producing nations.
8. His books are interesting and provocative.
- (A) His books are most exciting.
- (B) His books tend to make the reader angry.
- (C) His books are appealing and stimulate discussion.
- (D) His books are concerned with controversial topics.
9. The West Indies could have won the test match if Lara hadn't fallen ill suddenly.
- (A) The West Indies lost the test match because Lara was suddenly ill.
- (B) If Lara hadn't suddenly fallen ill, there was a possibility that the West Indies would have won the test match.
- (C) Lara caused the West Indies to lose the test match because he suddenly became ill.
- (D) There was no likelihood that the West Indies would have won the test match if Lara was ill.
10. So engrossed was he in his task that he did not hear his sister enter the room.
- (A) His task was so difficult that he did not observe his sister's entry.
- (B) He did not hear his sister enter the room because of the job he was doing.
- (C) His sister's entry did not attract his attention because he was enjoying what he was doing.
- (D) He was so preoccupied with what he was doing that he was unaware of his sister's entry.

Items 11 - 15

Instructions: Choose the word or phrase that is closest to OPPOSITE in meaning to the underlined word or phrase and mark your choice on your answer sheet.

11. We found her appreciative of the help that we had given her on this matter.

(A) unhappy about
(B) displeased at
(C) ungrateful for
(D) intolerant of

13. At the sound of the bell, the lower forms went reluctantly back to their classrooms.

(A) anxiously
(B) willingly
(C) hurriedly
(D) punctually

12. While the employers approved of his work habits, they objected to his radical views.

(A) fashionable
(B) informed
(C) conservative
(D) capitalist

14. The guest speaker's address was devoid of humour.

(A) full of
(B) indicative of
(C) presented with
(D) controlled by

15. As a result of the available evidence, the landlord was apprehended.

(A) released
(B) evicted
(C) cautioned
(D) summoned

Items 16 - 20

Instructions: Some of the following sentences are unacceptable because of inappropriate grammar, spelling, idiom or vocabulary. Some sentences are acceptable as they stand. No sentence contains more than one inappropriate element.

Select the ONE underlined part that you feel is inappropriate and choose the corresponding letter. If the sentence is acceptable as it stands, choose D. Mark your choice on the answer sheet.

16. He divided the sweets among you and me.
(A) (B) (C)

No error.
(D)

19. When you are compiling the estimates
(A)

for reccurent expenditure do you include
(B) (C)
breakages? No error
(D)

17. One of the admirable characteristics of the
(A)

young is that they are not easily scared.
(B) (C)

No error.
(D)

20. It is my privilege to give you some advise
(A) (B)

concerning proper nutrition. No error
(C) (D)

18. In "A House for Mr Biswas", Naipaul

shows that how a man may struggle against
(A) (B)

great odds to achieve those things that he
(C)

most desires. No error
(D)

Items 21 - 30

Instructions: Read the following poem carefully and then answer items 21 - 30 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

A Bad Day

I cannot smile today
nor be pleasant today
I do not like people today
and particularly hate children today
5 today I am sad
today I am mad
at everybody and everything
I hurt today
I can't love today
10 nor see beauty
today
I wish the wind away
No, I can't be happy today
I looked down the future today
15 and began to die today

Cynthia Wilson, "A Bad Day".
Hibiscus bears a blue flower - poems and musings.
Cynthia Wilson, 2004, p.64.

21. Which of the following is NOT true of the poet?
- (A) She cannot smile today.
(B) She does not love children.
(C) She cannot see beauty in anything.
(D) She cannot be sad today.
22. Which of the following words BEST describes the poet's mood?
- (A) Melancholic
(B) Jovial
(C) Reflective
(D) Anxious
23. The word "particularly" (line 4) is NEAREST in meaning to
- (A) sincerely
(B) truthfully
(C) especially
(D) rarely
24. Which of the following is an example of alliteration?
- (A) "cannot smile today" (line 1)
(B) "can't love today" (line 9)
(C) "wish the wind away" (line 12)
(D) "began to die today" (line 15)
25. The poet repeats the word "today" for
- (A) consistency
(B) balance
(C) enhancement
(D) emphasis
26. "I looked down the future today" (line 14) is an example of
- (A) personification
(B) simile
(C) onomatopoeia
(D) metaphor

27. The words "not see beauty" (line 10) mean that the poet cannot

- (A) see her friend
- (B) appreciate life
- (C) visit her house
- (D) see nature

28. The tone of the poem can BEST be described as _____

- (A) depressing
- (B) peaceful
- (C) sarcastic
- (D) apprehensive

29. The poet "began to die" (line 15) probably because

- (A) the weather was gloomy
- (B) future events did not look promising
- (C) she could not control her anger
- (D) there were too many people around her

30. The poet's intention is to

- (A) inform us of her bad day
- (B) express her hatred of people
- (C) show us her dislike of children
- (D) tell us of her unhappy condition

Items 31 - 39

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer items 31 - 39 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

The moment Aldrick stepped outside, Carnival hit him. And his heart grew big, and he felt a softness flow over him, and on the street, the steelband and masqueraders were assembling. The months of practising and sewing and painting and building were flowing together in the stillness of the morning under the eyes of women and children who had awakened from sleep and dressed hurriedly to come out and watch their band, to see their people, to admire them and cheer them and to accompany them, to tramp the pavement, while the masqueraders occupied the street, as a sort of guard, right into Port-of-Spain.

It hit him, the red and black and gold and green; the colours and the feathers and the satin, and the people's faces with that look in their eyes, and the smell of cologne and face powder, and the smell of grease and the look of wonder on the children's faces, and the little fellows with sailors caps on; and what reverence and what awe as they alone in the whole world had the real eyes to see the real thing, to see heroes, to see giants, to see gods.

And watching, fascinated by it all, as if he were seeing with the boys' eyes, Aldrick felt a tallness and a pride, felt his hair rise on his head. And full of brimming with furious tears, Aldrick felt again the fierce love and hope that he had doubted in himself, felt again a sense of mission: felt that yes, there was a place here for him, that there was something to say yes to, and people before whom and on whose behalf he could dance the dragon. With a strong, piercing scream, he stepped into the street, his chains rattling, his arms outflung, his head lolling, in a slow threatening dance of the Beast, so that the people of the Hill turned to him, recognizing him, said "Yes! Yes! That is Dragon!"

31. The words "... hit him" (lines 1, and 8) are repeated to emphasise the impact of

(A) the excitement of Carnival
(B) objects being thrown
(C) the noise and the smells
(D) collisions taking place

32. "And his heart grew big ..." (line 1) means that Aldrick

(A) wanted to cry
(B) felt a great pride
(C) was urged to join the band
(D) felt a strong anger

33. Lines 2 and 3 of the extract suggest that preparations for Carnival entail a great deal of

(A) waste
(B) tension
(C) excitement
(D) hard work

34. The repetition of "and" in line 3 of the extract is intended to show

(A) the specific activities involved in costume making
(B) the boring nature of the many activities before Carnival itself
(C) the continuous nature of the activities involved in preparing
(D) how important each of the activities is to the band

35. "... women and children... dressed hurriedly" (lines 4 - 5) suggests that

- (A) time was passing quickly
- (B) no one wanted to miss the spectacle
- (C) the people had overslept that morning
- (D) people did not have much clothing to put on

36. "... what reverence and what awe..." (line 11) reveals that the spectators were

- (A) bewildered
- (B) engrossed
- (C) apprehensive
- (D) captivated

37. The reaction of the people to Aldrick's dance was one of

- (A) surprise and fear
- (B) laughter and cheers
- (C) recognition and approval
- (D) recognition and fear

38. The last sentence of the extract (lines 17-19) gives the impression that Aldrick's dance is intended to be

- (A) frightening
- (B) amusing
- (C) surprising
- (D) cheerful

39. In describing Carnival, the writer makes use of the senses. Which one of the following senses is NOT used in this extract?

- (A) Taste
- (B) Sight
- (C) Smell
- (D) Hearing

Items 40 - 45

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer items 40 - 45 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

Celestial Island is not just for tourists; many from neighbouring islands find themselves hopping over to Celestial Island during a long weekend for a quick and enjoyable escape. That is because people know that this tiny isle has so much to see, so much to do and so much to offer.

- 5 All the leisure time you have during your stay can be spent in so many different ways. Maybe you would prefer to spend your holiday sleeping-in late into the afternoons, awaking to be served a scrumptious breakfast in bed, lounging around the pools or beaches, basking in the warm sun, souvenir shopping or mingling with the locals and acquainting yourself with a new and fascinating culture. With so many different things to do on the island, your choices are endless.

- 10 There are so many engaging ways to experience the pleasing sights, sounds and scenery of this island paradise. Sightseeing, though, is by far one of the most fun and dynamic ways of learning about all that Celestial Island has to offer.

- 15 A nice alternative to the typical travel itinerary, with scheduled times for specific activities, is to do what comes naturally here and take it slow, stop as you go, pull over at lookout points and rest-stops for an eat and a drink while chatting and admiring some extraordinary places of interest.

The most developed areas of Celestial Island are relatively modern; with numerous trendy hotels, a few resorts and scattered modest guest-houses can be found, in addition to the international airport.

- 20 Along the Caribbean coast there is a seemingly infinite stretch of white sandy beaches, which is a favourite with tourists. Bliss Town is the vibrant and scenic capital and port that is the hub of all the island's activities.

*Adapted from "Top Tourists Towns".
The Guardian, August 22, 2006, p. 61.*

40. What is the writer's MAIN purpose?

- (A) To inform readers about Celestial Island
- (B) To describe the important features of Celestial Island
- (C) To encourage visitors to visit Celestial Island
- (D) To state the location of Celestial Island

41. Which of the following does the writer use in the attempt to persuade?

- (A) Facts
- (B) Opinions
- (C) Statistical data
- (D) Strong language

42. The advertisement is intended for

- (A) holiday-makers
- (B) businessmen
- (C) escaped persons
- (D) cultural artistes

43. The repetition of the words "so much" and "so many" in paragraphs 1 - 3 serves to

- (A) highlight the writer's lack of words to describe the island
- (B) emphasise the variety of attractions on the island
- (C) summarise the list of activities for visitors
- (D) convey the writer's excitement about the variety of things to do

44. Which of the following expressions BEST sums up the experiences on Celestial Island?

- (A) "your choices are endless" (lines 8 - 9)
- (B) "engaging ways" (line 10)
- (C) "nice alternative" (line 13)
- (D) "what comes naturally" (line 14)

45. Which of the following is the MOST suitable description of the island?

- (A) "fascinating culture" (line 8)
- (B) "island paradise" (line 11)
- (C) "infinite stretch of white sandy beaches" (line 20)
- (D) "scenic capital" (line 21)

Items 46 - 50

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer items 46 - 50 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

It has come to the attention of the Ministry that certain misinformation is being circulated about the ABC Land programme. We therefore think it necessary to publish the following information.

5 The first phase of the ABC Land programme is in progress. Before being given a card, persons will be subjected to means testing administered by the Ministry of Social Development over the next three months to confirm their eligibility for the programme. After this process is completed, low- or no-income persons who are interested in participating in the programme will be notified via the media, to contact the ABC Secretariat at 800 - ABCD (2223) or at its sub-offices. The relevant addresses and numbers will be published subsequently.

10 Contrary to information appearing in the media, the Ministry states categorically that ALL citizens who are considered vulnerable, and are experiencing grave difficulty because of low or no income to obtain basic food to feed themselves and their families will be eligible to apply for participation in the programme, subject to a means test and/or home visit. Vulnerable persons may also be referred to the ABC programme by government social workers.

15 The ABC Secretariat can be contacted at this time for further information about the programme or to report queries which may arise with the use of the card. The Ministry thinks those persons who have expressed an interest in participation in the programme and asks for your understanding and support as we complete the first stage of distribution.

46. Before being given an ABC card, persons have to

- (A) be working at the Ministry of Social Development
- (B) wait for three months
- (C) visit the office at the Ministry of Social Development
- (D) undergo a means test

47. People who are eligible to apply for the card are

- (A) all citizens
- (B) social workers
- (C) parents of families
- (D) low- or no-income persons

48. Members of the public who need information about the programme may contact

- (A) the media
- (B) a government social worker
- (C) the ABC Secretariat
- (D) the Ministry of Social Development

49. The passage is MOST likely a

- (A) report
- (B) press release
- (C) short story
- (D) letter to the editor

50. It is MOST probable that the writer of this passage is

- (A) a press reporter
- (B) a concerned citizen
- (C) the secretary of the ABC Secretariat
- (D) an official of the Ministry of Social Development

Items 51 - 60

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer items 51 - 60 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

Dear Mr Lopez:

I strongly believe that our school should organise a girls' soccer team, and I am not alone in this belief. After conducting a survey among the junior and senior girls at our school, I found that fifty girls would be interested in trying out for a soccer team.

To discover how similar teams have worked out at other schools, I have talked to Ms Young, the girls' soccer coach at Fairfax High. When I asked her how the team has benefited the girls and the school, she said: "The girls on my team have become close friends. They help each other with everything - homework, personal problems." She added, "Their grades have improved - they've become better all-round students and that's always good for a school."

A soccer team would be of equal benefit to all the girls at our school. Just like the girls at Fairfax, many girls here have trouble making friends. A soccer team might help them adjust to school life.

Moreover, it would be simple to start a soccer team. I've already talked to my fellow gym teacher, Ms Jordan. She is willing to take on the responsibility of coaching the team. The question of where to practise isn't a problem either, since the playing field isn't used after three o'clock on Tuesdays and Thursdays. All we need

51. "Trying out" (line 6) means the same as

- (A) fitting on uniforms
- (B) being a part of
- (C) seeking selection
- (D) practising for a game

52. The purpose of the first sentence in paragraph 1 is to suggest that the writer's point of view is one that is

- (A) shared
- (B) logical
- (C) unanimous
- (D) beyond dispute

53. What did the writer do in order to discover how similar teams worked out at different schools?

- (A) Conducted surveys in other schools
- (B) Observed practice sessions at other schools
- (C) Spoke with an official at another school
- (D) Visited a number of schools with girls' teams

54. Which of the following is a statement of opinion?

- (A) A soccer team would be of equal benefit to all the girls at our school.
- (B) The question of where to practise isn't a problem either.
- (C) She is willing to take on the responsibility of coaching the team.
- (D) I found that fifty girls would be interested in trying out for a soccer team.

55. Which of the following is NOT cited as a benefit of a soccer team?

- (A) Teamwork
- (B) Friendships
- (C) Improved grades
- (D) Keen competition

56. "Mr Lopez", to whom the letter is addressed, is MOST likely a

- (A) student
- (B) gym teacher
- (C) school official
- (D) newspaper editor

57. Paragraph 3 implies that the establishment of a soccer team at the writer's school would

- (A) allow students to get used to school life more easily
- (B) reveal how difficult it was for girls to form friendships
- (C) show that there was little difference between two schools
- (D) result in the school having a superior team to that at Fairfax

58. "All-round students" (lines 16 - 17) are students who are

- (A) high achievers in examinations
- (B) excellent in sports and athletics
- (C) good in all their academic subjects
- (D) good in academics and co-curricular activities

59. The MAIN purpose of the letter is to

- (A) promote the benefits of sports for girls
- (B) win support for the establishment of a girls' soccer team
- (C) argue that all girls may be skilled at soccer
- (D) obtain better practice facilities for the girls' soccer team

60. Which of the following techniques does the writer use to support her argument?

- ☒ I Citing evidence
- ☒ II Quotation of experts
- ☒ III Showing the advantages

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.